

THE HUMANE SYSTEM FRAMEWORK (HSF-7)

A Philosophical-Technical Architecture for Ethical, Safe, and Self-Correcting
Human-Centered Systems

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Abstract

Human-centered systems have historically produced irreversible harm due to structural flaws in authority, interpretation, and epistemic control. These failures were not merely cultural accidents but architectural defects: unilateral decision-making, opaque power, erasure of subjective experience, and the absence of feedback loops. The Humane System Framework (HSF-7) introduces seven axioms that collectively define the minimum conditions for a moral, safe, and self-correcting system. The framework integrates philosophical grounding with technical architecture, producing a model suitable for clinical, institutional, and AI-mediated environments.

Executive Summary

The HSF-7 framework is built on seven non-negotiable axioms:

Irreversible Harm Threshold

Subject Perspective as First-Class Data

Power Must Be Observable and Auditable

Harm Must Flow Upstream

No Single Authority Can Define Reality

Human Dignity Is the Non-Negotiable Constant

The System Must Be Co-Created With the Person

These axioms form a unified architecture that prevents historical harm patterns and ensures that systems remain humane even under stress.

1. Background and Historical Failure Modes

Human-centered systems — from early asylums to modern psychiatric institutions — have repeatedly failed due to structural flaws rather than individual malice. These failures include:

Irreversible physical interventions

Epistemic domination

Unilateral interpretation

Coercive protocols

Hidden power structures

Lack of feedback mechanisms

The HSF-7 framework addresses these failures at the architectural level, ensuring that no system can reproduce them regardless of culture, training, or individual intent.

2. The Seven Axioms

Each axiom is a hard constraint. Violation of any axiom collapses system integrity.

2.1 Axiom 1 — Irreversible Harm Threshold

2.2

Principle

Irreversible interventions require near-impossible thresholds.

Rationale

If an action cannot be undone, the cost of error is infinite. Therefore, the threshold for such actions must be extreme.

Requirements

Red-Tier classification

Multi-layer verification

Cooling periods

External oversight

Reversibility preference

Immutable logging

2.3 Axiom 2 — Subject Perspective as First-Class Data

2.4

Principle

The subject's narrative is primary data, not a symptom.

Rationale

Epistemic harm occurs when systems overwrite or reinterpret a person's experience without consent.

Requirements

Immutable subject narrative block

Separate interpretation block

Contradiction preservation

Subject narrative required in all decisions

2.3 Axiom 3 — Power Must Be Observable and Auditable

Principle

No hidden authority. No invisible decisions.

Rationale

Unobserved power is historically correlated with harm.

Requirements

Time-stamped logs

Public-audit ledger

Multi-key override

Plain-language reasoning visible to the subject

External review for high-impact decisions

2.5 Axiom 4 — Harm Must Flow Upstream

2.6

Principle

When harm occurs, the system must update — not the person.

Rationale

Systems that blame the subject for harm they caused cannot self-correct.

Requirements

Harm ledger

Automatic review

System-update protocols

No blame-shift

Review board activation

2.5 Axiom 5 — No Single Authority Can Define Reality

Principle

Reality must be multi-perspective, not dictated.

Rationale

Unilateral interpretation of a person's mind is structurally unsafe.

Requirements

Multi-channel verification

Transparent interpretations

Contradiction preservation

No hidden notes

2.7 Axiom 6 — Human Dignity Is the Non-Negotiable Constant

2.8

Principle

A person must never be reduced to a label, risk category, or protocol.

Rationale

Dehumanization is the root failure mode of historical systems.

Requirements

Consent-first workflows

Identity-protection protocols

Dignity-preserving language

No dehumanizing framing

2.7 Axiom 7 — The System Must Be Co-Created With the Person

Principle

A humane system is collaborative, not imposed.

Rationale

Systems that exclude the person from interpretation and planning reproduce historical harm.

Requirements

Participatory planning

Shared authority

Adaptive feedback loops

Personalized thresholds and interventions

3. System Integrity Equation

A system is moral only if:

$$[\text{Integrity}] = A_1 + A_2 + A_3 + A_4 + A_5 + A_6 + A_7]$$

If any axiom is violated:

$$[\text{Integrity}] = 0]$$

This is a binary condition, not a gradient.

4. Architectural Model

Core Components

Red-Tier Intervention Engine

Subject Narrative Registry

Power Audit Layer

Harm Feedback Engine

Interpretive Multiplicity Module

Dignity Safeguard Layer

Co-Creation Interface

System Flow

Subject narrative captured

Multi-perspective interpretation

Reversibility analysis

Intervention planning

Power audit logging

Harm detection

System update

Subject feedback integration

5. Failure Mode Analysis

Historical systems failed due to:

Epistemic erasure

Unilateral authority

Irreversible interventions

Coercive protocols

Lack of transparency

Absence of feedback loops

HSF-7 eliminates these failure modes by embedding safeguards at the architectural level.

6. Ethical Foundations

HSF-7 is grounded in:

Human dignity

Epistemic justice

Reversibility ethics

Distributed authority

Participatory design

Structural transparency

These principles ensure that systems remain humane even under stress.

7. Future Applications

HSF-7 is suitable for:

Clinical systems

AI-mediated decision systems

Crisis-response systems

Institutional governance

Cognitive-interface systems

Future human-AI collaborative environments

8. Conclusion

HSF-7 provides a rigorous, implementable architecture for humane systems. By enforcing seven non-negotiable axioms, it ensures that no system can repeat the irreversible, epistemic, or dehumanizing harms of historical models.

Appendix A — Definitions

Irreversible Intervention: Any action that cannot be undone.

Subject Narrative: The person's own account of their experience.

Epistemic Harm: Harm caused by erasing or overriding a person's interpretation.

Red-Tier Action: An intervention requiring extreme thresholds.

Appendix B — Implementation Blueprint

Immutable logging

Multi-key override

Harm ledger

Subject narrative registry

Co-creation interface

Dignity safeguard layer